

June

*"I like people who smile when
it's raining"*

and another quote

*Creativity comes from a conflict
of ideas*

Donatella Versace



June info

- ❖ Latin name for June is *Junius*.
 - Maybe named after Juno, Jupiter's wife and the Roman goddess of marriage.
 - Or the name might come from *iuniores*, younger ones after the *maiores* of May.
 - Its **Finnish** name is *kesäkuu* meaning summer month.
- ❖ In **Polish** June is *czerwiec*, **Ukrainian** *červen'*, **Czech** *červen*, **Belarusian** *červjen'* from the word for **red** likely referring to ripening cherries, strawberries, and other red fruits
- ❖ In **Irish** it's *Meitheamh*, **Welsh** *Mehefin*, **Breton** *Mezheven*, and **Cornish** *Metheven* – meaning mid-summer and in **Scottish Gaelic** *Ògmhios* is new moon. Any more languages?

June's birthstones



pearls



alexandrite



moonstone

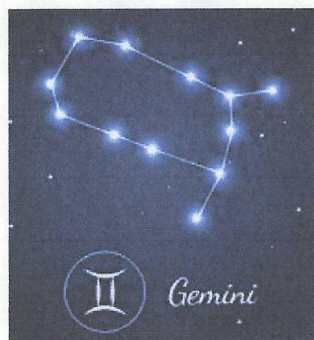
Flowers of the month



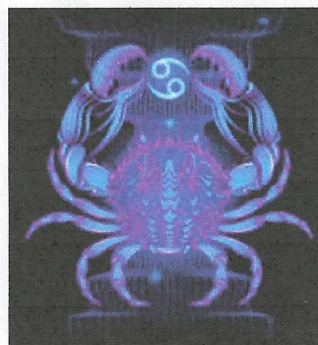
rose and honeysuckle



June's zodiac signs

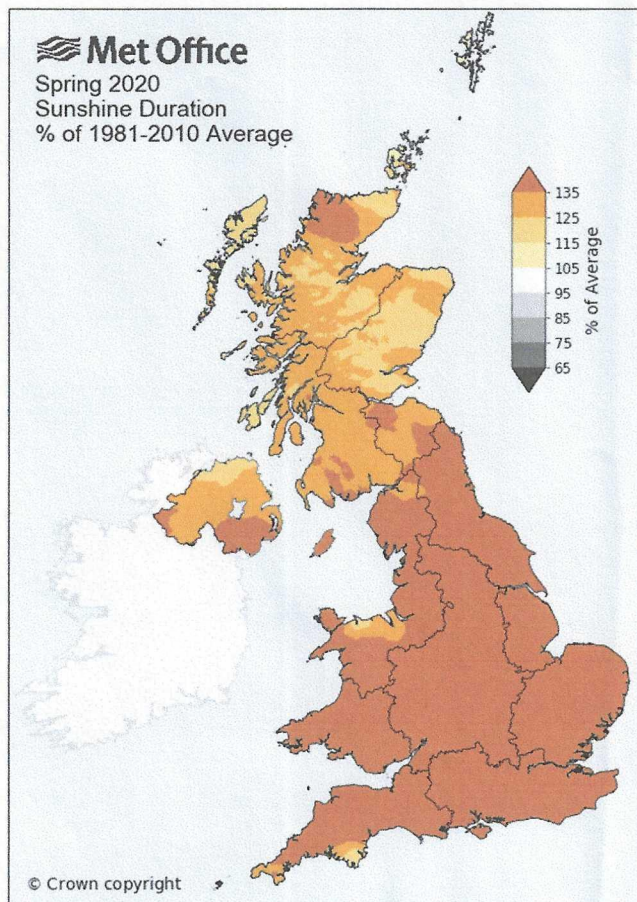


and Cancer

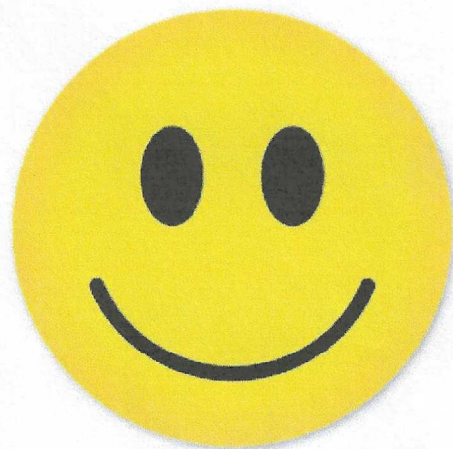


June

Catch up and don't forget Fathers' Day



According to the Met office
It has been the sunniest Spring
on record for the UK
and the driest May on record
in England."



June is National Smile Month

Thanks to Terry

Last month I said that the scores of people visiting the park were special because their litter **Stays at Home**. I'll modify that – thanks to Terry who everyday picks up litter in the mornings the park always looks litter-free.

Willow Here

and



June



Willow Gone

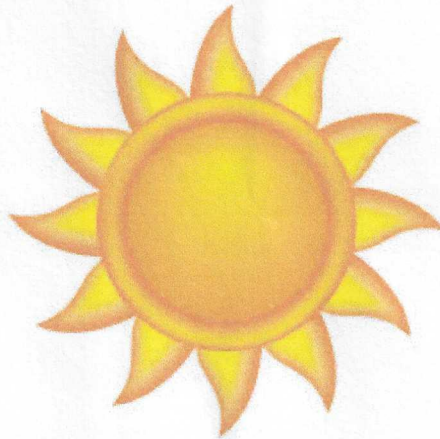
Risinghurst Ready



But where are the



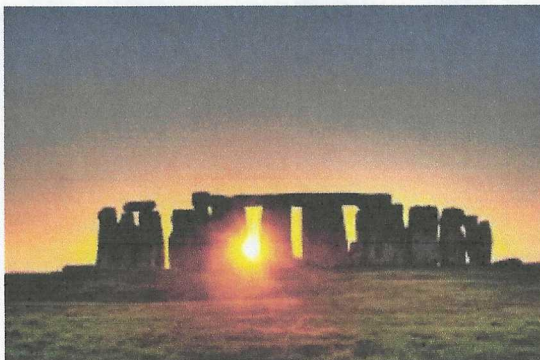
Solstice



It's Summer Solstice at 22.43 on Friday, 20th, when our longest day, on Saturday 21st, lasts 16.41.26 hours

Earliest sunrises for us in Oxford happen before Midsummer Day on 4 mornings, 15-18 June. at 04.45

Celebrated all over the world (in December for the Southern Hemisphere) with Dragon Boats, World Music Day, merrymaking, feasting and bonfires



Thousands gather at Stonehenge



The Maypole is a symbol of Midsummer celebrations in Sweden



Can't get to the seaside yet (well we can't) so how about dancing round a bonfire in the park? But perhaps not - it's too dry for bonfires.

In late 14th-century John Mirk of Lilleshall Abbey in Shropshire, gives the following description:

"At first, men and women came to church with candles and other lights and prayed all night long. In the process of time, however, men left such devotion and used songs and dances and fell into lechery and gluttony turning the good, holy devotion into sin."

COUNT THE STARS

Back in February CPRE, the countryside charity, encouraged everyone in all parts of the country to take part in the 2020 Star Count to highlight the problem of light pollution.



Artificial light leaks from our buildings and roads and this can affect our view of truly dark skies. We were asked to count the number of stars we could see within the quadrangle constellation of Orion, the Hunter, excluding the 4 corner stars.

In Risinghurst, my count was 3, the stars on his belt. His sword was just a blur.

30+ stars	Truly dark skies
26 - 30	Dark skies
21 - 25	Fairly dark skies
16 - 20	Some light pollution
11 - 15	Light pollution
6 - 10	Severe light pollution
0 - 5	Very severe light pollution

The results

- 2,500 people took part
 - Just 3% of people live in an area with truly dark skies
 - 61% saw 10 stars or fewer, indicating severe light pollution

CPRE say “We clearly have a long way to go to combat light pollution here in the UK.

But what’s heartening is how many of you value a view of the night sky.

88% of people that took part thought more needed to be done to protect dark skies where they live and a huge 97% thought that gazing at the stars has a positive impact on their wellbeing.”

There is a map of the results on the CPRE website cpre.org.uk/what-we-care-about/nature-and-landscapes/dark-skies/star-count-2020-results